Introduction to Styles

Styles: A style is a collection of all formatting information, which you want to save and then apply on the document.

Importance of Styles:

Speeds up the formatting process.

Ensures uniform formatting throughout the document

Using Style allows you to shift your focus from appearance of the document to the content of document.

Enhances the document's professional look with consistent formatting.



Style Categories

Writer provides six Style categories, which are as follows:

Page Style It is used for fomatting pages. It defines basic page layout like page size, its margin, placement of header and footer, footnote, borders and background.

Paragraph Style It is used for fomatting paragraphs. It includes tab stops, text alignment, line spacing and borders.

Character Style this styling is used on block of letters, i.e. word(s). It allows changing the text colour, text size, highlighting text and emphasising it.

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Frame Style Frames are like containers, which can hold text, graphics & lists. Frame Styles allows to format a frame by specifying its size, position, border and how the text is placed around the picture.

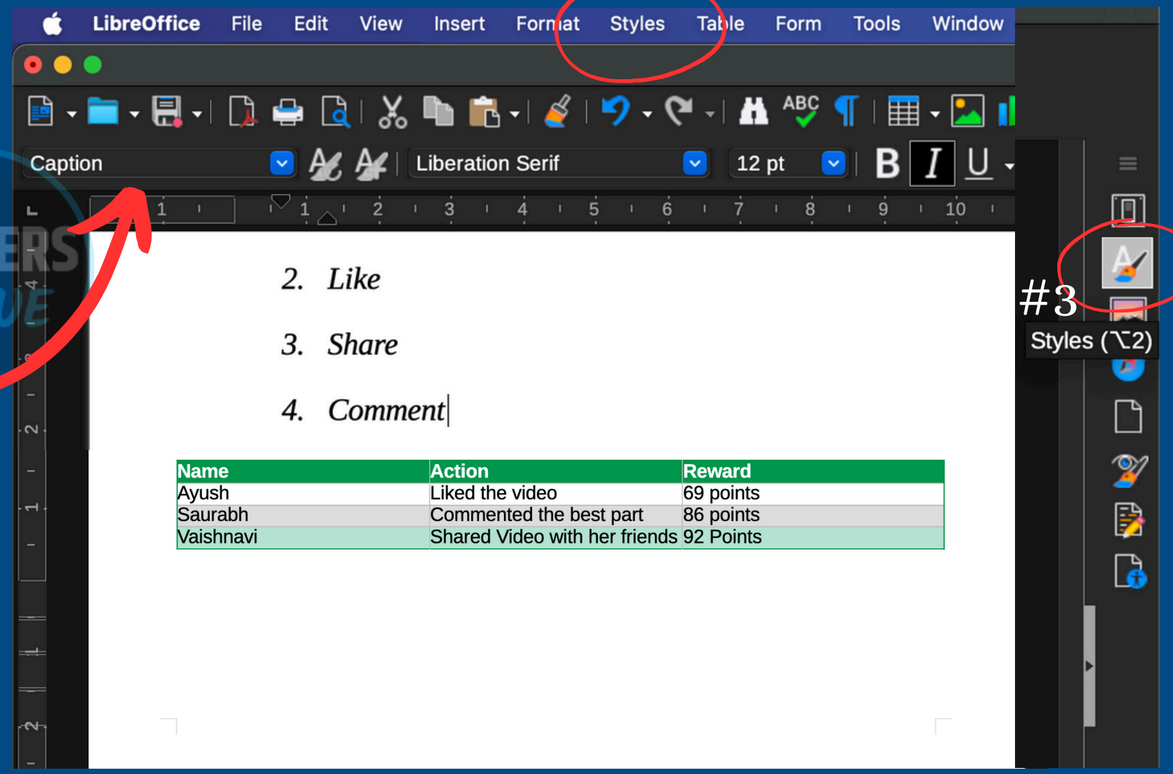
List Style It can be used to style lists by putting numbering or bullets of a different kind or specify numeric format.

Table Style using tables, a large amount of information can be organised and presented effectively. Table Style category allows to format a table by adding borders, using different text or border colour(s), aligning text inside the table, having different patterns or text colour.

Styles and Formatting

There are many predefined Styles in Writer, which can be accessed by using the following methods:

- **Using Style option from Menu Bar**
- **Using Style Drop Down list box**
- **Using Sidebar Menu**
- **Using keyboard shortcut — F11 function key.**



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Applying Styles

Step 1 Select the text to be formatted. The selected text may be a collection of characters, words, lines, paragraph, page, frame or table.

Step 2 To format the selected text, choose appropriate style category by clicking the button from the top of the Styles bar.

Step 3 A list of styles for that category appears. Double click on the desired style to apply to the selected text.

Fill Format

This method is useful when a same style is to be applied at many places scattered in the document.

Step 1 Open the document to be styled.

Step 2 Open the Styles window and select the desired style category and then desired style from drop down list.

Step 3 Select Fill Format button.

Step 4 To apply the selected style, take the mouse pointer to desired location and click.

Step 5 To quit Fill Format option, click the Fill Format button again or press the Esc key.

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Creating and Updating a New Style

Custom Style can be created From Selection and by using drag and drop.

From Selection

Step 1 Select the portion of document to change its appearance. Format it as per the requirement.

Step 2 From the buttons at the top of the Style menu, choose the category for which a new style is to be created.

Step 3 Select Style action button. Click on New Style from Selection.

Step 4 In Create Style dialog window, type the name of new style.

Step 5 Click OK to save the name of new style.

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Creating and Updating a New Style

Using Drag and Drop

Step 1 Select the portion of document to change its appearance. Format it as per the requirement.

Step 2 From the buttons at the top of the Style menu, choose the category for which a new style is to be created.

Step 3 Click on the desired style under which, new style is to be created.

Step 4 From the document drag the selected portion of text to the Style Menu.

Step 5 In the Create Style dialog box type the name of new style.

Step 6 Click OK button to save the name of new style.

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Drag and Drop cannot be used to create a Page Style.

Updating a Style

Step 1 Select the portion of document to change its appearance. Format it as per the requirement.

Step 2 Go to Style menu, and click on the button to update.

Step 3 Using Style Action button, click on Update Selected Style.

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Load Styles

The last option, in Style Action button of Style Menu is Load Styles. It is used to copy styles from an existing template or document.

Step 1 In the Styles Menu, click on the Load Styles.

Step 2 In the Load Styles dialog box, choose the category of your document.

Step 3 Find and select the desired template to copy styles from.

Step 4 Now select the options for the types of styles to be copied.

Step 5 Click OK to copy the styles.

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